Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

Introduction

The Brainstorming & Ideation Phase is the stage where ideas are generated, explored, and developed to solve a problem or meet a specific need. It encourages creative thinking and allows different possible solutions to be considered.

Objectives

- Generate a wide range of ideas.
- Understand the problem from different perspectives.
- Encourage creativity and innovative thinking.
- Identify possible solutions to the problem.
- Select ideas that can be developed further.

Common Techniques

- **Brainstorming:** Quickly generate many ideas without judging them initially.
- **Mind Mapping:** Organize related thoughts and ideas visually.
- **SCAMPER:** Improve an existing idea by using different creative prompts.
- **Sketching:** Represent ideas visually to make them easier to understand.

Key Steps

1. Define the problem clearly.
2. Collect relevant information and insights.
3. Generate as many ideas as possible.
4. Discuss and organize the ideas.
5. Evaluate and shortlist suitable ideas.

Importance

This phase helps teams move beyond obvious solutions and discover creative alternatives. It also promotes collaboration, improves problem-solving, and provides a strong foundation for developing and testing a final solution.